

Secure enough

Dear Vinit,
You have concluded your October editorial stating that anybody who uses a PC is in some way responsible for preserving the security of the rest of the world and that prevention is better than cure. True, but it's not always possible. You can either make something so secure that only a handful of people can use it, or you can create a system that is easy to use for most people and compromise security in the bargain. Windows is a prime example of the latter. Even if you were to build a fortress, it will never be impregnable. Hence, there is no real prevention for security lapses.

Hrishikesh
Via e-mail

Dear Hrishikesh,
The real security threat here is the people who exploit these technological loopholes and not the technology as such. Security will always be an issue till there are challenges for hackers to meet. Virus authors will always try to create newer, better viruses—it's their way of finding self worth and gaining boasting rights. Till we all don't grow up and consider the ramifications of our actions on the people around us, the only solution would be to educate and create awareness about the problem. That is the only way to ensure prevention.

digit

Don't you like me?

Hey Guys,
I've been regularly sending my PC problems to sos@jasubhai.com, but none of



them have been featured in the magazine. Please let me know if the address is correct. I've managed to solve most of my queries myself, but it did take me a long time

to find the correct information. Anyway, do keep up the good work!

Aditya Kumar Sharma
Via e-mail

Hi Aditya,
We go through hundreds of e-mail every month and featuring them all in the Q&A section is just not possible because of space constraints. Hence, we select letters where the problem is more universal, so as to provide a generic solution for other computer users. Also, guaranteeing a personalised answer to each e-mail or promising to solve every computer problem that's thrown our way might sound exciting but is quite unrealistic.

digit

Ban that spam!

Dear Vinit,
Thank you for the useful article in the October 2002 issue, 'Spam-protect Your Inbox', where you've made a special mention of Hotmail spam filters. I had a terrible problem with my Hotmail account. Even though I would only use my Hotmail ID for chatting, I used to receive loads of junk mail. I always wondered, 'How on earth did they get my address?' Now thanks to this article, I've learnt how to configure the anti-spam filters on my Hotmail account.

Y.K. D'Souza
Via e-mail

Hi,
I'm sure that most of us wouldn't mind spam too much if they offered authentic deals and useful information. But the absence of governing bodies and the extremely low costs of e-mail marketing are responsible for making spam one of the worst disasters on the Internet. We can help discourage spammers by supporting services such as SpamNet (www.cloudmark.com). Hopefully, in the years to come, a few of these services will become successful in combating spam.

digit

Bhakti geet

Hi Vinit,
My Dad had been asking me for a long time to record a few devotional songs on the family computer from his cassette collection, and I told him that it was not possible without purchasing specialised hardware. But after reading the 30 Minutes Expert in the October issue, I've finally managed to fulfil his request! On being asked how I managed to accomplish this seemingly impossible task, I replied, "Sub kash Digit ka karmal hai!"

K. Poornachandra
Via e-mail

Hi,
Shhhh...not so loud! We don't want to let the cat out of the bag that it's possible to convert your old audiocassettes into digital MP3s. Imagine the sleepless nights this would give the recording industry! :-)

digit

Short Bytes Filtered by Digit

Hi Guys,
I simply love Digit and eagerly await the beginning of the month when I can get my hands on the next issue of Digit. In today's age of hyped up marketing and product peddling, Digit helps in sorting through the clutter. Keep up the good work.

Aditya Kumar Sharma
Via e-mail

Free Linux

Hi Vinit,
Here is a tip for people who don't want to spend 11 grand on Red Hat Linux (reviewed in the October issue). Go to any bookstore and buy the book titled *Red Hat Linux 7.3 Bible* and you'll get the three installation disks free! Okay, so the book costs Rs 499, but it's still a bargain when compared to the retail box.

Anu
Via e-mail

Goof Ups

■ The Top Guns story on Page 122 (Digit, September 2002) incorrectly credits the "Who you need besides a miracle" quote from the movie *The Matrix* to Trinity, when it was actually said by Tang. Thanks to M. Ignatius for pointing this out.

■ It took Monish Prem's eyes to point out that in the graph on Page 78 of the System Suites test (Digit, October 2002), we've interchangeably defrag times taken by Norton SystemWorks 2002 and Ontrack SystemSuite 4.0.

■ In the Bazaar section of the October 2002 issue, we've mentioned Visualan Technologies as the contact for the MP3-VCD Player (Page 82) Mercury Pocket DV Camera (Page 86). The correct contact is Kobian India Pvt Ltd (Phone: 080-5566626).

Notice any goof-ups? Write to goof@jasubhai.com

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